Power
Learn
Project

SpendWise

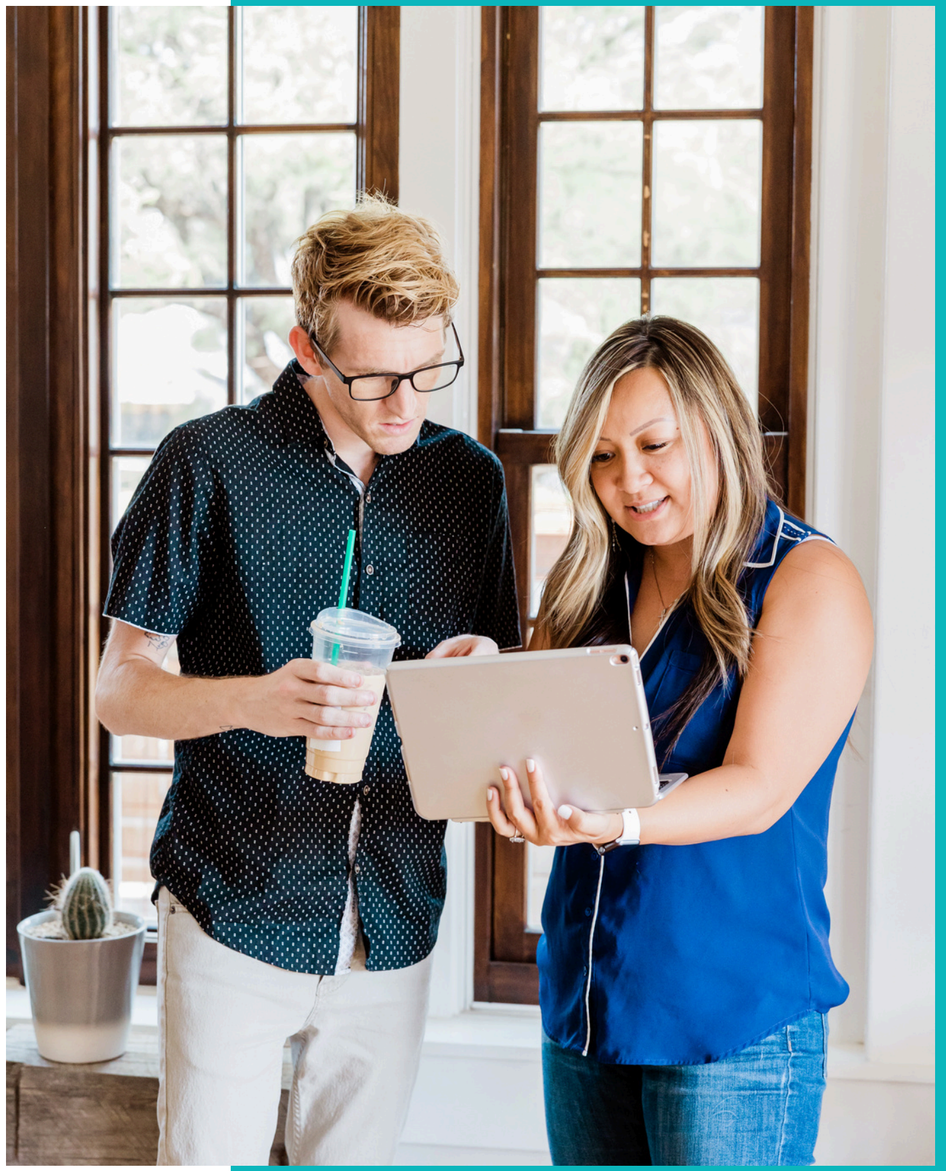
Smart Personal Budget & Expense Tracker



Presented by Salat Farah | Cloud Computing Track |
Live App: salat-spendwise.netlify.app

Write the Problem Statement

- Students and young earners in Kenya struggle to track daily small expenses (transport, food, utilities) until their monthly budget runs out unexpectedly.
- Manual notebooks are easily lost, while complex banking apps lack simple, real-time category alerts.

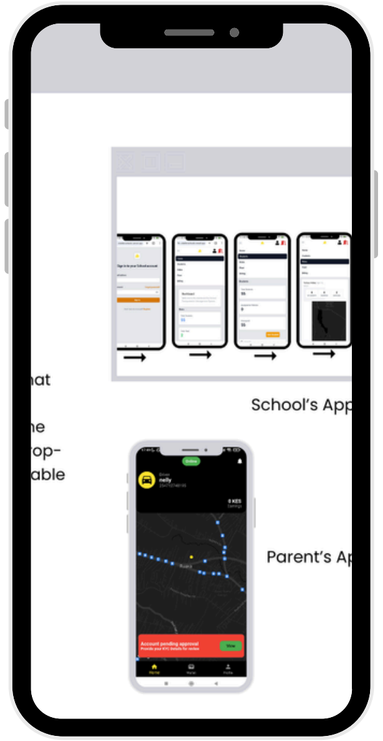


Write Your Solution

- A lightweight, responsive web application that lets users set a monthly budget, log expenses by category, and receive instant visual spending alerts before overspending.
- Live Demo Link: https://salat-spendwise.netlify.app

Product

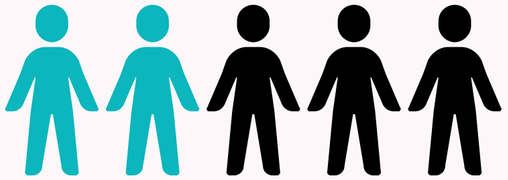




What the product does:

- *Real-Time Budget Dashboard: Instant calculation of Total Budget, Total Expenses, and Remaining Balance in KSh.*
- *Smart Alert Banner: Automated warnings when spending crosses 80% (Caution) or exceeds 100% (Warning).*
- *Category Breakdown: Dynamic tracking across Housing, Food, and Transport.*

Target Market



- Primary Users: University students, youth trainees, and young professionals managing monthly stipends or allowances.
- Impact: Builds financial discipline, prevents mid-month cash shortfalls, and works smoothly on both mobile phones and laptops.

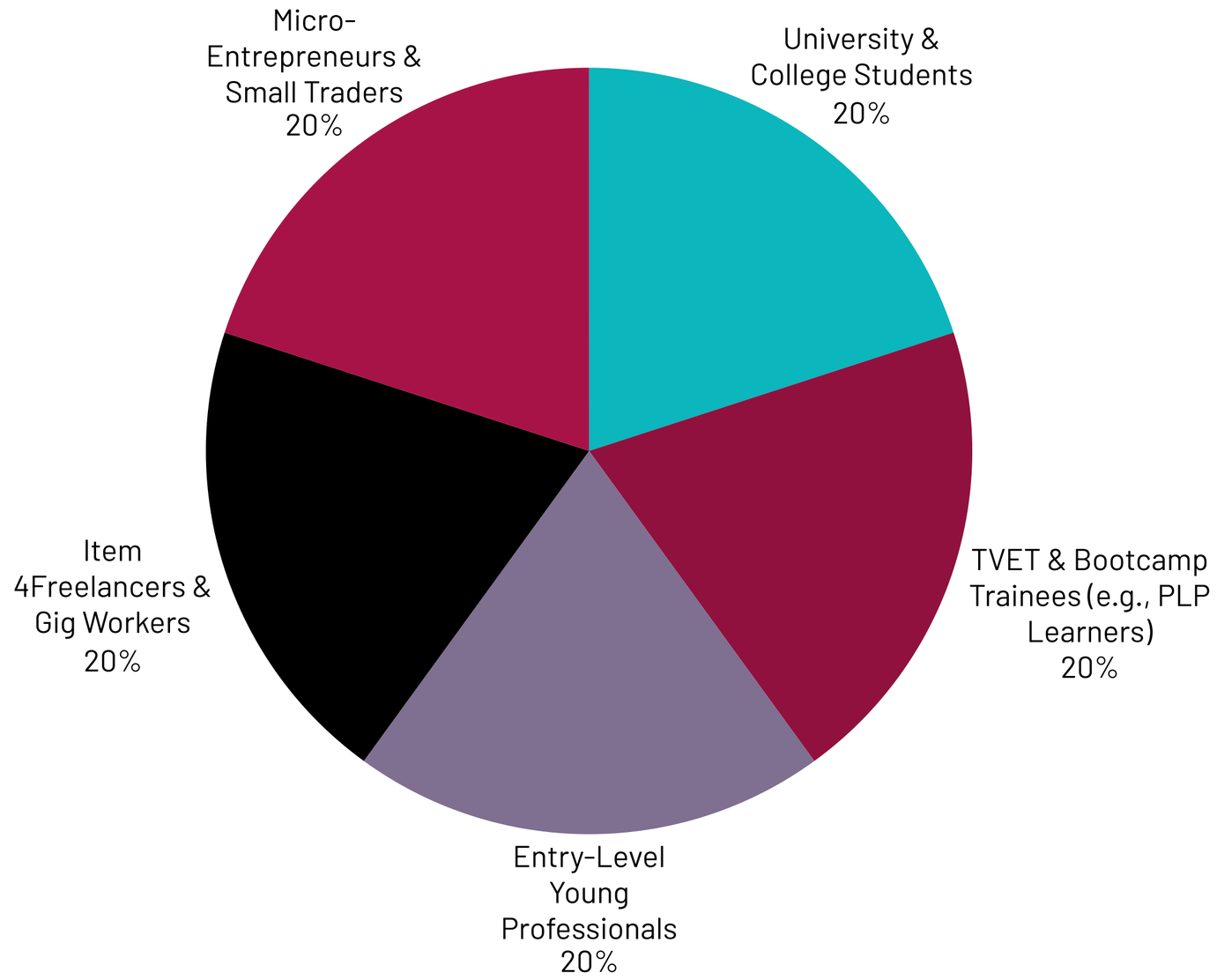
Market Size

Target Market Opportunity (Kenya):

• TAM (Total Addressable Market): 35M+ mobile money & digital finance users across Kenya managing daily KSh transactions.

• SAM (Serviceable Available Market): 6M+ university students, TVET trainees, and young professionals aged 18–35 relying on monthly stipends and entry-level salaries.

• SOM (Serviceable Obtainable Market): 50,000+ students and youth trainees across Garissa and Kenyan tech hubs adopting lightweight mobile budgeting tools in Year 1.





Competitors

Existing Alternatives:

• Paper Notebooks & Spreadsheets: Free and familiar, but easily lost, slow to calculate, and offer zero overspending alerts.

• Heavy Banking & Global Apps (Mint, YNAB, PocketGuard): Feature-rich, but overly complex, subscription-gated, and built for foreign currencies rather than everyday KSh budgeting.

• Mobile Money Statements (M-Pesa): Show past transaction history, but do not categorize budgets or warn users before money runs out.

Why SpendWise Is Different:

• Built for Local Simplicity: Instant Kenyan Shilling (KSh) tracking across everyday essentials (Housing, Food, Transport) with zero clutter.

• Proactive Budget Alerts: Real-time visual warnings at 80% (Caution) and 100%+ (Overspending) help students stop overspending before it happens.

• Lightweight & Accessible: Runs fast in any mobile or desktop browser with no paid subscriptions or heavy app downloads.

Competitive Advantage

What makes us unique?

1. Proactive Overspending Protection

• Unlike passive expense logs, SpendWise triggers instant visual banners at 80% spent (Caution) and 100%+ (Warning) so users adjust habits before running out of cash.

2. Zero-Friction Local Design (Built for KSh)

• Tailored specifically for Kenyan students and young earners with instant Kenyan Shilling (KSh) calculations, everyday categories (Housing, Food, Transport), and zero setup complexity.

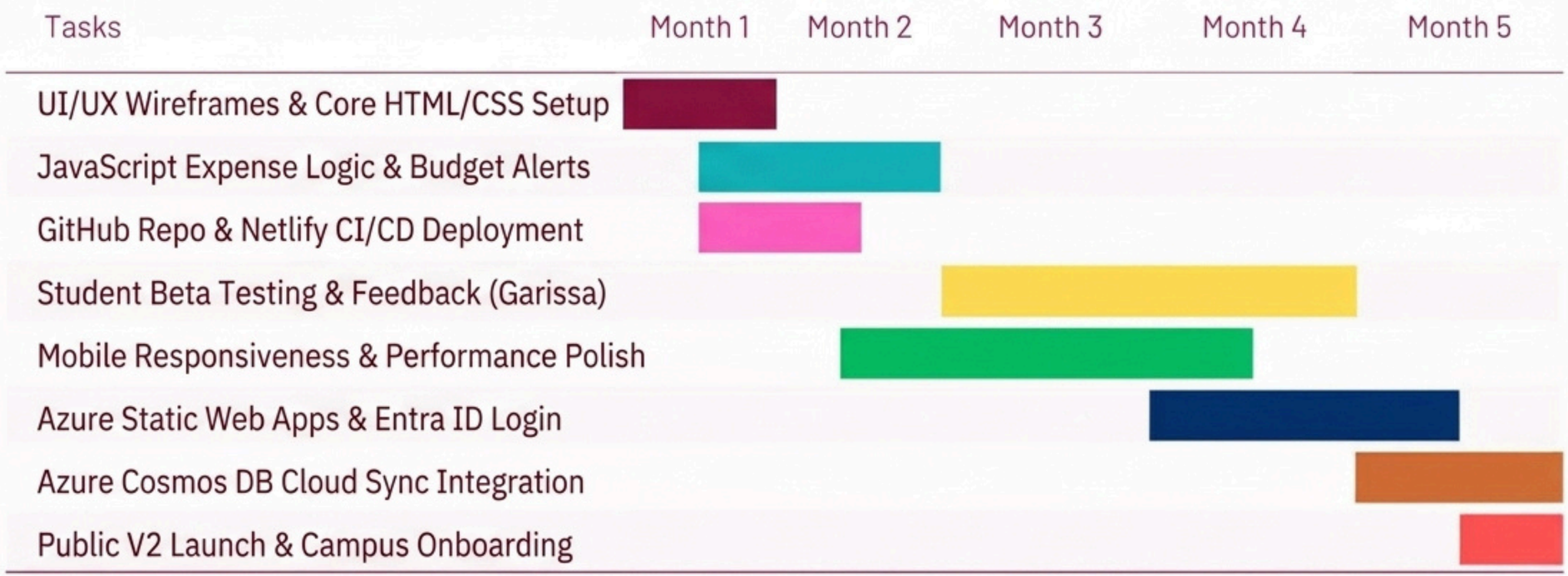
3. Ultra-Lightweight & Low-Data Performance

• Loads in under a second on any mobile or desktop browser without heavy app downloads, subscriptions, or high data usage—ideal for low-connectivity areas.

4. Cloud-Ready Architecture

• Built on modern CI/CD workflows (GitHub + Netlify) and engineered to scale into Microsoft Azure (Entra ID authentication + Cosmos DB) for secure multi-device syncing.

Project Traction



Business Model



How We Make Money (Freemium Model):

- **Free Core Tier:** Basic KSh budget tracking & spending alerts for students.
- **SpendWise Pro (KSh 150/month):** Multi-device Azure cloud sync, PDF reports & unlimited categories.
- **Institutional Licenses:** Bulk financial literacy dashboards for universities, TVETs & SACCOs.

Profit Margins:

- **~75%–80% Gross Margin:** Low serverless & static cloud hosting costs on Microsoft Azure keep overhead minimal as user volume scales.

Go To Market

Phase 1: Campus & Cohort Launch (Months 1–2)

- Onboard PLP peers, university students, and TVET trainees in Garissa via WhatsApp groups, student clubs, and QR-code posters.

Phase 2: Digital & Social Growth (Months 2–3)

- Share short TikTok, Instagram Reels, and X (Twitter) budgeting challenges demonstrating instant KSh expense tracking.

Phase 3: Youth & FinTech Partnerships (Months 3–4)

- Partner with youth empowerment hubs, SACCOs, and financial literacy workshops to bundle SpendWise into trainee onboarding.

Phase 4: Referral & Campus Ambassadors (Months 4–6)

- Reward student ambassadors with free SpendWise Pro upgrades for referring active peer groups across Kenyan universities.

Social Impact

- **SDG 1 — No Poverty:** Empowers students and low-income youth to track daily KSh spending, curb impulse expenses, and build financial resilience against mid-month cash shortfalls.
- **SDG 4 — Quality Education:** Promotes practical financial literacy and responsible stipend management so university and TVET students stay focused on completing their studies.
- **SDG 8 — Decent Work & Economic Growth:** Equips young earners, freelancers, and micro-entrepreneurs with accessible digital budgeting habits to manage income sustainably.
- **SDG 10 — Reduced Inequalities:** Delivers a free, lightweight, low-data budgeting tool accessible on basic smartphones across underserved regions like Northern Kenya.

Our Ask

- Seeking KSh 500,000 ($3,800) in pre-seed grant funding alongside technical mentorship and campus partnership introductions.
- Use of Funds:
  - 45% Product & Cloud Infrastructure (Microsoft Azure hosting, Cosmos DB scaling & Entra ID authentication)
  - 35% Campus Onboarding & User Acquisition (Student ambassador drives across Garissa and Kenyan universities)
  - 20% UI/UX Research, Beta Testing & Financial Literacy Content

Team Members

Current Founder & Planned Growth Roles



SALAT FARAH

Founder & Lead Cloud Developer

OPEN ROLE

UI/UX Designer (Phase 2)

OPEN ROLE

Backend & Cloud Engineer (Phase 2)

OPEN ROLE

Campus Growth Lead (Phase 2)

Thank you!

Salat Farah | Founder & Lead Cloud Developer
Live App: salat-spendwise.netlify.app
GitHub: github.com/Farah-salat/personal-budget-tracker
Email: salatfarah219@gmail.com
Phone: +254 726 507 152
LinkedIn: Farah Salat

Location: Garissa, Kenya